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## How do we communicate?

**‘Communication is the key to success’ applies strongly to transdisciplinary collaboration. Below, you discover what to consider when communicating. Read and discuss this page especially together with your team. After all, communication always exists between multiple people.**

**What do you need for smooth communication in your team?**

**First: a common vision. To create such a vision with each other, you need a common language. To achieve this, you need to understand your own and each other's backgrounds. Some terms may be self-evident to you and your colleagues, but people from other disciplines or fields may interpret them very differently. Only when you are all aware of this, it is possible to really understand each other.**

**Tip: a tool for communication in diverse teams**

**You can use the [Theory of Change exercise](#), for example, to capture diversity in a transdisciplinary team. This exercise is used in co-creation processes to;**

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- - Create a clear mission plan;
  - - Get the noses in the same direction;
  - - Uncover hidden misconceptions;
  - - Analyse how to achieve long-term goals.

**What should you continuously pay attention to?**

**Truly understanding each other requires constant reflection. This may sound heavy, but it basically comes down to always continuing to ask questions about everything you say and hear. Do I understand it correctly? And: do others understand correctly what I want to communicate? Feeling free and safe to speak out in the team is essential. This way can you cross disciplinary boundaries and transdisciplinary knowledge emerge.**

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**A few questions to go through by yourself and together:**

- Which communication rules do you think are important?**
  
- How easily do you give and receive negative feedback?**
  
- How easily do you give and receive compliments?**
  
- Are you a better listener or speaker? And why?**

**Finally, three simple but golden tips:**

**1. Agree on rules for providing feedback with each other. How and when do you formulate feedback? Make sure everyone feels safe and free in this.**

**2. Agree on consultation moments and communication, including the use of**

**3. Make sure everyone in the transdisciplinary project is heard. Remember the ambition of equality. Note down agreements on this aspect.**